



MOMMIES MATTER

Meditation Scripts

for the Tender Mama

Eight guided meditations for every chapter of pregnancy —
from the first whispered hello to the quiet days after birth.

Read these aloud to record your own audio, or use them as a guide
for personal practice. Each script is paced for slow reading
with natural pauses at every paragraph break.

Written by Helena-Ann

Tender Trimesters · Premium Library



MEDITATION 1 OF 8

Welcome, Little One

First Trimester Bonding

****Duration****: ~6 minutes · ****Use case****: Early pregnancy, when mama wants to connect with baby but can't feel them yet · ****Category****: First Trimester

Find a place where you can be still. A chair, the edge of your bed, the floor if that feels kind to your body today. Settle in. Let your hands rest in your lap, palms open, like you are holding something precious.

Because you are.

Close your eyes if it feels safe to do so. If not, soften your gaze. Let it fall on something neutral — the wall, the ceiling, the light through the window.

Take a breath in, all the way down to the place where your baby is growing. And let it out, slow and long, like you are blowing a feather across a room.

Again. Breathe in, soft and full. And out, releasing anything you have been carrying today. The worry. The lists. The question you forgot to ask the doctor. Let it go for now. It will be there when you come back.

...

Right now, inside your body, something is happening that no one can fully see. A heart the size of a poppy seed is beating. A tiny spine is curling into the shape of a question mark. Fingers, no bigger than the tip of a pen, are forming.

You may not feel pregnant yet. You may not look pregnant yet. But you are a mother now, and your body knows. Your body has known since before the test turned positive.

Place one hand on your lower belly, just below your navel. Just rest it there. You do not have to do anything. You do not have to feel anything. Just let your hand be a warmth.

If your mind wanders, that is okay. Minds do that. Notice where it went, and gently bring it back to the warmth of your hand. Back to the small dark quiet place where your baby is.

...

Say hello.

Not out loud, unless you want to. In your mind, in your heart, in the language only the two of you share.

"Hello, little one. I am here. I am your mother."

You do not have to know what to say. You do not have to feel a wave of love right this second. Some mamas fall in love the moment they see two lines. Some mamas fall in love at the first ultrasound. Some mamas fall in love three weeks after birth, exhausted, in the middle of the night, when the baby finally latches and they think, oh. There you are.

All of these are normal. All of these are okay. Love is not a single moment. Love is the thousand small choices you are already making. The prenatal vitamin. The water you drank this morning. The way you said no to that glass of wine. The way you are sitting here right now, with your hand on your belly, choosing to be present.

That is love. You are already doing it.

...

Breathe in, and imagine the breath traveling down, down, down, all the way to your baby. A soft golden light, if that helps you picture it. Or just a warmth. Or just a feeling of presence.

Breathe out, and imagine your baby surrounded. Held. Safe.

Inhale. Reach down. Exhale. Surround.

One more time. Inhale. Reach. Exhale. Hold.

...

Your baby does not need a perfect mother. Your baby needs you. Tired, scared, hopeful, nauseous, you. You are enough for this little one. You have been enough since the very first day.

When you are ready — no rush — wiggle your fingers. Wiggle your toes. Take one more breath, all the way down to your baby. And let your eyes open, slow and soft.

Welcome to the first of many quiet moments together. You are going to be wonderful at this. You already are.

MEDITATION 2 OF 8

Through the Wave

First Trimester Nausea

****Duration**:** ~5 minutes · ****Use case**:** When nausea hits and mama needs relief, even for a few minutes ·

****Category**:** First Trimester

If you are listening to this, you are probably feeling awful. So let's not waste time.

Wherever you are — the bathroom floor, the couch, the car parked outside the office — let yourself be there. Do not try to push through. Do not try to pretend you are fine. You are not fine right now, and that is allowed.

Close your eyes, or soften your gaze. Let your shoulders drop away from your ears. Let your jaw unclench. Your tongue, let it fall away from the roof of your mouth. These small places hold more tension than you realize.

Breathe in through your nose, slow and cool, like sipping air through a straw. Let it fill your chest, your ribs, your belly.

Breathe out through your mouth, soft and warm, like you are fogging a mirror. Long. Longer than the inhale. This tells your nervous system: we are safe. We can rest.

Again. In through the nose, cool and slow. Out through the mouth, warm and long.

...

Nausea is a wave. It rises. It crests. It falls. It does not stay at the same level forever, even when it feels like it will. Your job is not to stop the wave. Your job is to ride it.

When the next wave rises, do not fight it. Do not tense against it. Tension makes it worse. Instead, soften. Let your body go heavy. Let your shoulders drop. Let your belly be soft.

Imagine the wave lifting you, the way ocean water lifts a leaf. You do not have to do anything. You just have to float.

The wave will crest. It will feel terrible for a moment, maybe two. And then it will begin to fall. Slowly at first, then faster. The nausea will recede, the way ocean water pulls back from the shore.

You are still here. You rode it. You are still here.

...

Place one hand on your belly, the other on your heart. The hand on your belly says: I am taking care of you, little one. The hand on your heart says: I am taking care of you, mama. Both are true. Both matter.

Breathe into both hands. In through the nose. Out through the mouth. Slow. Steady. Kind.

If you can, take a small sip of water. Just one. Do not think about the next sip. Just this one. Cold, clear, going down. Your body knows what to do with it.

If you cannot, that is okay too. Just breathe. The wave will pass. It always does.

...

You are not weak for needing to lie down. You are not failing for being unproductive today. You are growing a human being from scratch, and your body is doing the most extraordinary work it has ever done. Every minute of nausea is a minute of your body saying: I am taking this seriously. I am flooding you with hormones because something miraculous is happening.

This is not a glitch. This is the work.

And the work is temporary. Most mamas feel better by week fourteen. Some take longer. Some never feel sick at all. There is no right way. There is only your way, and you are walking it, one wave at a time.

When you are ready, take one more breath. In through the nose. Out through the mouth. Let your eyes open.

You can do five more minutes. And then five more after that. That is all you ever have to do.

MEDITATION 3 OF 8

The Glow Returns

Second Trimester Joy

****Duration****: ~6 minutes · ****Use case****: Second trimester, when energy returns and mama wants to embrace this chapter · ****Category****: Second Trimester

The fog is lifting. You can feel it, can't you? The bone-deep exhaustion of the first trimester is beginning to ease. The nausea comes less often. Food tastes like food again. You laughed today, really laughed, for the first time in weeks.

Welcome to the second trimester. This is the chapter the books call the honeymoon. The morning sickness fades. The bump arrives, soft and round and proud. The baby starts to move — first little flutters, like a butterfly trapped in your belly, then real kicks, real rolls, real hello-I-am-here moments.

Let's spend a few minutes here together, in this good chapter. Let's not skip past it.

Find a comfortable seat. Or lie on your left side, pillow between your knees, if that feels better. Place both hands on your belly, one above the other. Take a breath in, all the way down to your hands. Let it out, slow and warm.

Again. In, down to your hands. Out, soft and slow.

Notice your baby. Not just the idea of your baby, but the actual physical sensation of your baby in your body right now. The weight. The warmth. Maybe a kick, maybe a stretch, maybe just a presence you have learned to recognize.

Say hello. Just in your mind. "I feel you. I am here."

...

This is the time when pregnancy starts to feel real. Your body is changing in ways you can see. Your belly has a shape now. Your breasts are heavier. Your hair might be thicker, your skin smoother — the famous pregnancy glow, which is real, and which is just blood. Your body is making 50 percent more blood than it did before. Of course you glow. You are full of life.

Breathe into that. In, and feel the fullness. Out, and let yourself be proud of what your body is doing.

You are not the same person you were three months ago. You are softer in some places, stronger in others. You are slower, and that is not a flaw. That is your body asking you to pay

attention. To notice. To be here for this.

Take a moment to thank your body. Not for being beautiful, though it is. Not for being perfect, because no body is. Thank your body for showing up. For doing the work. For carrying this baby through every single day, even the hard ones, even the ones you didn't think you could get through.

Place a hand on your heart. "Thank you," you can say, out loud or in your mind. "Thank you, body. We are doing this together."

...

The second trimester is also when you will start to dream about this baby. Not just at night, but in the day. You will catch yourself imagining what they will look like. Whose eyes. Whose laugh. You will picture a first birthday, a first day of school, a future you cannot yet see.

Let yourself dream. There is no harm in it. There is no jinxing. There is only hope, and hope is what carries us through the long stretch between now and birth.

Breathe in, and let a picture form. Your baby, in your arms, in your home, in your life. The way the light will fall. The way they will smell. The way your heart will feel, cracked open in a way you did not know was possible.

Breathe out, and let the picture soften. You do not need to hold onto it. It will come true in its own time.

...

One more breath together. In, all the way down to your baby. Out, all the way back up to your heart.

You are in a good chapter right now. Soak it in. Take the bump photos. Eat the thing you have been craving. Tell your partner, or your best friend, or your mom, that you are happy today. You do not have to be happy every day. But when you are, name it. Let it be real.

When you are ready, wiggle your fingers and toes. Roll your shoulders. Take one more breath. And let your eyes open, slow and soft.

The glow is yours, mama. Wear it well.

MEDITATION 4 OF 8

Strong Enough

Third Trimester Body Confidence

****Duration**:** ~7 minutes · ****Use case**:** Late third trimester, when body feels heavy and birth feels close ·

****Category**:** Third Trimester

You are in the home stretch now. Thirty-something weeks. Maybe thirty-six. Maybe thirty-eight. The baby is big enough that you can see them move from across the room — a foot sliding across your belly, a bottom pushing up under your ribs, a head dropping low into your pelvis.

Your body is heavy. Your back aches. Your hips feel like they are made of loose parts. You waddle when you walk, and you did not waddle before. You get out of breath bending over to tie your shoes.

All of this is normal. All of this is hard. Let's take a few minutes together, just the two of us, before the world asks anything else of you.

Find a comfortable position. Lying on your left side with pillows is ideal. Sitting up with support works too. Whatever lets your body be most at rest.

Close your eyes. Take a breath in, slow and deep, all the way down to the bottom of your belly. Let it out, long and soft, like a sigh that has been waiting all day to be released.

Again. In, slow and full. Out, long and releasing.

One more. In, fill your body with air. Out, let everything heavy sink into the surface beneath you. The bed. The couch. The floor. Let it hold you. You do not have to hold yourself up right now.

...

Your body has been doing impossible things for months now. It has grown a skeleton, a nervous system, a beating heart, ten perfect fingers, ten perfect toes. It has made a placenta from scratch — a brand-new organ, just for this baby, that will be born and then quietly let go.

Your body knows what it is doing. Even when you do not.

Place both hands on your belly. Feel the curve of it. The weight of it. This is not fat. This is not bloat. This is your baby, and the home your body built for them, and the fluid that keeps them safe, and the blood that feeds them.

You are not too big. You are not too small. You are exactly the size your body needs to be to grow this exact baby.

Breathe into your hands. In, and feel the fullness. Out, and let yourself soften around it.

...

Some days you look in the mirror and you do not recognize yourself. Your face is rounder. Your hips are wider. There are marks on your belly — red, purple, silver — that were not there a year ago.

These marks are not flaws. They are the record of what your body has done. Each one is a place your skin stretched to make room for a life. Each one says: I grew. I changed. I became something new.

You do not have to love them today. You do not have to love them ever. But you can let them be what they are: evidence. Proof. A signature your body signed on itself that says, I did this. I made a person.

Place a hand on one of those marks, if you can find one. Just rest your fingers there. You do not have to say anything. Just acknowledge. Just witness.

This is your body, and it is strong.

...

Soon — maybe in a few weeks, maybe in a few days — your body will do the hardest, most extraordinary thing it has ever done. It will open. It will push. It will bring your baby from the inside to the outside, from the dark to the light, from a possibility to a person.

You may be scared. That is normal. Birth is big. It is the biggest thing a body can do.

But here is what I want you to know: your body was made for this. Your pelvis will open. Your cervix will thin. Your uterus will contract, in waves, just like the waves of nausea in the first trimester, and each wave will bring your baby closer to your chest.

You do not have to do it perfectly. You do not have to do it the way the books say. You just have to show up, breathe through each wave, and let your body lead. It knows the way. It has known since the beginning.

Breathe in, and trust your body. Breathe out, and let the fear soften. Just a little. Just enough.

...

You are strong enough for this. You have been strong enough for every hard day so far — the morning sickness, the anxiety, the sleepless nights, the what-ifs. You will be strong enough for birth, too. Not because you are unbreakable, but because you are willing. Because you keep showing up. Because you love this baby more than you fear the pain.

That is what strong means. Not fearless. Willing.

When you are ready, take one more deep breath. In, all the way down. Out, all the way up.

Wiggle your fingers. Wiggle your toes. Roll your ankles. Let your eyes open, slow and soft.

You are almost there, mama. Just a little further. You've got this.

MEDITATION 5 OF 8

Opening

Birth Prep Visualization

****Duration****: ~8 minutes · ****Use case****: Late third trimester or early labor, to practice surrender ·

****Category****: Birth Prep

This meditation is for practicing the most important skill you will need in labor: letting go. You can do it now, in late pregnancy, to prepare. You can also do it in early labor, between contractions, to remind your body what it knows.

Find a comfortable position. Lying down is best, but sitting works too. Whatever lets you be most soft.

Close your eyes. Take a breath in, slow and easy, all the way down to your belly. Let it out, longer than the inhale, soft and warm.

Let your shoulders drop. Let your jaw unclench. Let your hands open, palms up, like you are receiving something.

Breathe in again, and this time, picture the breath as a soft golden light, filling your chest, your belly, your hips. Breathe out, and let the light settle, calm and warm, in the center of your body.

Again. In, fill with light. Out, settle and soften.

...

Now bring your attention to your pelvis. The bowl of your hips. The base of your body. This is where your baby will pass through. This is the door.

Picture a flower. Any flower you like — a rose, a lotus, a daisy, a peony. Picture it closed, petals folded tight, at the center of your pelvis.

This flower has been closed for a long time. That was right. That was protective. Your body kept it closed to keep your baby safe.

But now, slowly, gently, the flower is ready to open.

Breathe in, and picture one petal loosening. Just one. Softening at the edge. Beginning to unfurl.

Breathe out, and let it open, just a little. No rush. No force. Just a gentle, natural unfolding.

Again. Breathe in, and another petal loosens. Breathe out, and it opens.

In, loosen. Out, open.

In, soften. Out, unfold.

...

This is what your cervix is doing, in real life, as labor begins. It is softening. It is thinning. It is opening, millimeter by millimeter, to let your baby through.

You do not have to make it happen. Your body is doing it. You only have to let it. You only have to soften, the way the flower softens. You only have to trust, the way a petal trusts the sun to open it.

Breathe in, and let your body soften. Breathe out, and let the flower open a little more.

If your mind tightens — if fear comes, if doubt comes, if the what-ifs crowd in — just notice. Do not fight them. Fighting makes you tight, and tight is the opposite of open.

Instead, breathe into the tightness. Breathe into the fear. Let it be there, like a cloud passing across the sky. And then breathe out, and let it pass. The sky is still there. The flower is still opening.

...

Picture the flower fully open now. Petals wide, soft, glowing. Your cervix is open. Your body is ready. Your baby is moving down, slowly, gently, with each breath you take.

Breathe in, and your baby descends a little. Breathe out, and your body opens to let them through.

You are not pushing your baby out. You are opening to let your baby come through. There is a difference. Pushing is force. Opening is surrender. Your body knows how to do both. But the opening is the part you can practice.

In, descend. Out, open.

In, soften. Out, release.

...

In labor, each contraction will be a wave. The wave will rise. It will crest. It will fall. Your job is not to stop the wave. Your job is to ride it.

When a wave comes, breathe in slowly. Breathe out long. Let your body go heavy. Let your shoulders drop. Let your jaw unclench. Let your hands open.

Soft jaw, soft pelvis. Soft shoulders, soft cervix. The body mirrors itself. Where you hold tension at the top, you hold tension at the bottom. So soften the top, and the bottom will follow.

Breathe in. Breathe out. Ride the wave.

When the wave falls, rest. Do not think about the next one. Just rest, here, in this breath, in this moment. You have everything you need for this wave. The next one will have its own breath.

...

You are going to do this hundreds of times before your baby is born. Each time, you will soften. Each time, you will open. Each time, you will ride the wave.

And then, one day soon, your baby will be here. In your arms. On your chest. Wet and warm and crying their first cry.

Picture that moment. The light. The sound. The weight of your baby, finally here, finally real. The way your heart will crack open, the way the flower opened, and you will be different forever.

Breathe into that moment. Let it fill you.

Breathe out, and let it soften. It is coming. You do not have to hold it. It is coming.

...

Take one more breath, slow and deep. In, all the way down to your baby. Out, all the way up to your heart.

Wiggle your fingers. Wiggle your toes. Roll your shoulders, slow and easy. Let your eyes open when you are ready.

You are going to birth this baby. Your body knows the way. You just have to let it open.

MEDITATION 6 OF 8

Rest Now, Mama

Sleep & Insomnia

****Duration****: ~10 minutes · ****Use case****: 3am, can't sleep, mind racing, body uncomfortable · ****Category****: Sleep

It is the middle of the night. You should be asleep. You are not.

Maybe you woke up to pee, again, and now you cannot get back. Maybe the baby is doing gymnastics and shows no sign of stopping. Maybe your hips ache. Maybe your mind has decided that now, at 3am, is the perfect time to worry about the birth, the nursery, the name you have not chosen, the money, the mother you are not sure you will be.

Let's not fight any of that. Fighting makes you more awake. Let's just be here, together, in the dark, and see if sleep comes. If it does not, that is okay too. Rest is rest, even with your eyes open.

Lie on your left side, if you can. Pillow between your knees. Pillow under your belly, if that helps. Pillow behind your back, so you do not have to hold yourself up. Be supported. Be held.

Close your eyes. Take a breath in, slow and easy, through your nose. Let it out, long and soft, through your mouth, like a whisper.

Again. In through the nose, cool and slow. Out through the mouth, warm and long.

One more. In. And out.

Let your shoulders sink into the mattress. Let your hips sink. Let your head be heavy on the pillow. You do not have to hold anything up right now. The bed is holding you.

...

Now we are going to do a body scan. Not to fix anything. Just to notice. Just to say hello to each part of you, the way you would say hello to a friend who has had a long day.

Start at your feet. Notice them. The left one, the right one. Are they warm or cold. Are they tense or relaxed. You do not have to change anything. Just notice.

Breathe in, and send a little warmth to your feet. Breathe out, and let them soften.

Move up to your calves. Your shins. The back of your knees. Notice them. Send a breath of warmth. Let them soften.

Your thighs. Your hips. The place where your legs meet your pelvis. This part has been working hard, carrying the extra weight. Thank it. Let it soften.

Your belly. Your baby. Rest a hand there, if you want. Just for a moment. Hello, little one. We are resting now. You can rest too.

Your lower back. The curve of your spine. Let it sink into the mattress. Let the bed take the weight.

Your shoulders. Drop them. They have been holding up the world. Let them drop.

Your neck. The back of your head. Your jaw — unclench it. Your tongue — let it fall away from the roof of your mouth. The space between your eyebrows. Soften. The space behind your eyes. Soften.

Your whole body, soft. Your whole body, heavy. Your whole body, held.

...

Now the mind. The mind is the loudest thing in the room right now. It wants to plan. It wants to worry. It wants to replay that conversation from yesterday and prepare the response you wish you had given.

Here is a secret about the mind at 3am: it cannot actually solve anything. The thoughts feel urgent. They feel important. But the mind that thinks at 3am is a tired mind, and a tired mind is not good at solving problems. It is only good at making them feel bigger.

So let's not solve anything tonight. Let's just let the thoughts pass.

Picture your mind as a sky. A wide, dark, soft sky. The thoughts are clouds. They drift in. They drift out. You do not have to grab them. You do not have to push them away. You just have to watch them pass.

A thought comes: "What if the birth goes wrong." Notice it. Label it gently: a worry. Let it drift across the sky. Let it go.

A thought comes: "I forgot to wash the onesies." Notice it. Label it: a to-do. Let it drift. Let it go.

A thought comes: "I am never going to sleep again." Notice it. Label it: a fear. Let it drift. Let it go.

The sky does not grab the clouds. The sky does not argue with the clouds. The sky just holds them, and lets them pass.

...

Breathe in, and the sky is wide. Breathe out, and the clouds drift on.

If a thought keeps coming back, that is okay. Let it come back. Notice it again. Label it again. Let it drift again. You do not have to do this perfectly. You just have to keep returning to the sky.

Return to the breath. In through the nose. Out through the mouth.

Return to the body. The soft, heavy, held body.

Return to the dark. The dark is not empty. The dark is restful. The dark is kind. The dark is the color your body wants right now.

...

If sleep comes, let it come. It may come like a soft fog, rolling in slowly, covering everything. It may come like a wave, pulling you under before you realize. However it comes, let it. You do not have to do anything. You just have to be here.

If sleep does not come, that is okay too. You are resting. Your body is resting. Your baby is resting. The to-do list will be there in the morning. The worry will be smaller in the morning. The morning will come, and you will be there for it, the way you have been there for every morning so far.

For now, just this. The breath. The body. The dark. The sky.

In. Out.

Soft. Heavy. Held.

In. Out.

...

If you are still awake when this meditation ends, do not get up. Do not check your phone. Do not try to be productive. Stay here. Breathe. Rest is rest, even with your eyes open. Rest is healing, even without sleep.

You are a good mother, even at 3am. Especially at 3am. The fact that you are here, in the dark, taking care of yourself so you can take care of your baby tomorrow — that is motherhood. That is the work.

The night will end. The morning will come. You will be okay.

Breathe. Rest. Soften.

MEDITATION 7 OF 8

This Too

Anxiety & What-If Spiral

****Duration****: ~6 minutes · ****Use case****: When the spiral starts — fear of miscarriage, fear of birth, fear of being a bad mom · ****Category****: Anxiety

Something has set you off. A blood spot on the toilet paper. A cramp that felt wrong. A friend's sad news. A statistic you read at 2am. A dream you cannot shake.

Your heart is racing. Your chest is tight. Your mind is running ahead of you, faster than you can follow, building worst-case scenarios, rehearsing tragedies that have not happened and may never happen.

Let's slow down together. Just for a few minutes. Just to catch your breath.

Sit down. Or lie down. Or lean against a wall, if that is where you are. Just stop moving. Just be still.

Put one hand on your heart. Put the other on your belly, where your baby is.

Close your eyes, if it feels safe. If not, soften your gaze.

Breathe in through your nose, slow and cool. Breathe out through your mouth, long and warm. Make the exhale longer than the inhale. This is the signal to your body that you are safe.

Again. In, slow and cool. Out, long and warm.

One more. In. Out, longer than in.

...

The mind in anxiety is a wild thing. It jumps from branch to branch, screeching, certain that there is danger. It is trying to protect you. That is what minds do. They scan for threat. They sound the alarm.

But the alarm is not always true. The alarm is just a feeling. A powerful, physical, overwhelming feeling — but a feeling, not a fact.

Notice the feeling. Do not try to push it away. Pushing makes it louder. Just notice. "I am feeling afraid right now." "My mind is showing me a scary future." "My body is reacting as if the scary thing has already happened."

It has not happened. Right now, in this moment, in this breath, you are here. Your baby is here. You are okay.

Say it softly, in your mind or out loud: "Right now, in this moment, I am okay. My baby is okay. We are okay."

Breathe in. Right now, I am okay. Breathe out. My baby is okay.

...

There is an old teaching: "This too shall pass." People usually say it about good things, to remind us not to get attached. But it is equally true about hard things. The fear will pass. The tight chest will pass. The scary thoughts will pass. They always do.

You have been afraid before. Many times. In the first trimester, before every ultrasound. In the bathroom, every time you wiped. At night, when the baby did not move for an hour and you poked your belly until they did.

You were afraid then. You are still here. The fear did not kill you. The fear did not predict the future. The fear was just fear.

Breathe in, and remember: I have been afraid before. Breathe out, and remember: I am still here.

...

Now, gently, bring your attention to your hand on your belly. The warmth of it. The weight of it. Just below, your baby is floating. Safe. Held in fluid, held in bone, held in you.

You cannot feel them right now, maybe. That is okay. They are there. They have been there all along.

Say hello. "Hello, little one. I am here. I am scared, but I am here. And I am not going anywhere."

You do not have to be calm to be a good mother. You do not have to be unafraid to be a good mother. You just have to be here. And here you are.

Breathe in, and let your hand be a warmth for your baby. Breathe out, and let your baby be a warmth for you.

...

If the scary thought is still there, do not fight it. Do not argue with it. Do not try to prove it wrong. Minds do not respond to logic when they are afraid.

Instead, just let it be there. Like a child having a tantrum in the next room. You can hear it. You know it is happening. But you do not have to go in. You do not have to fix it. It will tire itself out.

Breathe in, and let the thought be there. Breathe out, and let it be there. You do not have to do anything about it.

In. Out. Here. Now.

In. Out. Here. Now.

...

When the fear has softened — not gone, just softer — take one more breath, slow and deep. In through the nose. Out through the mouth.

Wiggle your fingers. Wiggle your toes. Let your eyes open, slow and soft.

If you need to call someone — your partner, your mom, your midwife, your doctor — call them. There is no shame in asking for reassurance. There is no weakness in needing to hear another voice say, "You are okay. The baby is okay. We will figure this out."

You are not alone in this. You were never meant to do this alone. Reach out. Let someone hold you, the way you are holding your baby.

You are going to be okay. This too shall pass. And you will still be here when it does.

MEDITATION 8 OF 8

You Did It, Mama

Postpartum

****Duration**:** ~7 minutes · ****Use case**:** Early postpartum — first days or weeks after birth · ****Category**:** Postpartum

You did it. You actually did it. The baby is here. Maybe in your arms right now. Maybe in a bassinet beside you. Maybe with your partner, or your mother, or a nurse, so you could have ten minutes alone to close your eyes and remember who you are.

Wherever you are, whatever hour it is, however your birth went — the way you planned or nothing like the way you planned — let's take a few minutes together. Just the two of us. Just to land.

Find a position that does not hurt. That might take some adjusting. Use the pillows. All of them. There is no dignity to protect right now. Just be comfortable.

Close your eyes, if you can. If the baby needs you, keep them open. You can do this meditation with your eyes on your baby.

Take a breath in, as deep as your body will let you. It might be shallow — your middle is sore, your insides are rearranging themselves back to where they were before. That is okay. Just breathe in what you can.

Let it out, slow and long, like a sigh that has been holding for nine months.

Again. In, what you can. Out, slow and long.

...

Your body just did the biggest thing it will ever do. It grew a person. It opened. It pushed, or it was cut, or it was reached into, and your baby was brought from inside you to outside you, from a dark watery world to this bright loud one.

You are allowed to be tired. You are allowed to be sore. You are allowed to be sad, even though the baby is here and healthy and you are "supposed" to be happy. You are allowed to feel everything all at once — joy and grief and relief and fear and a love so big it scares you.

All of that is normal. All of that is the postpartum experience. There is no right way to feel. There is only your way.

Place a hand on your belly. It is soft now. Softer than it was. There is no baby in there anymore. Just your organs, slowly finding their way home. Just your uterus, contracting back down with little afterpains that remind you it is still working.

Thank your body. Out loud, if you can. "Thank you. You did it. You did the hardest thing. I am proud of you."

You do not have to mean it yet. You do not have to love your body yet. Just say it. The body needs to hear it.

...

The baby is here. Take a moment to let that sink in.

For months, this baby was an idea. A name you whispered. A kick you felt. A shadow on an ultrasound. Now they are here. Real. Small. Sleeping or crying or looking at you with eyes that cannot quite focus yet.

You are a mother now. Not in theory. In practice. In the 3am feeds and the diaper blowouts and the moments when you cannot figure out why they are crying and you try everything and finally you just hold them and walk in circles and sing a song you do not remember the words to.

That is motherhood. Not the Instagram version. The real version. The tired, brave, ordinary, extraordinary version. And you are doing it. Right now. Today.

You are going to doubt yourself. A lot. You are going to Google things at 4am that you cannot un-Google. You are going to compare yourself to other moms who seem to have it together (they do not, by the way — they are just better at hiding it). You are going to wonder if you are enough.

You are enough. You have been enough since the moment your baby was conceived. You were enough through every hard day of pregnancy. You were enough through birth. You are enough now, in this messy, beautiful, exhausting chapter.

Breathe in, and let yourself be enough. Breathe out, and let yourself rest.

...

There will be hard days ahead. Days when the baby will not sleep. Days when you cry more than they do. Days when you look at your partner and think, "I love you but if you tell me to sleep when the baby sleeps one more time I will lose my mind."

Those days are coming. They are normal. They will pass.

And there will be golden days too. The first real smile. The first time the baby reaches for you on purpose. The first time they say "mama" and they mean you. The first time you make them laugh — really laugh, belly laugh — and you realize you would do every hard day again just to hear that sound.

You have so many golden days ahead. So many firsts. So much ordinary magic.

For now, just this. Just today. Just this breath. Just this baby, here, alive, yours.

Breathe in, and receive this moment. Breathe out, and let it be enough.

...

When you are ready — no rush — wiggle your fingers. Wiggle your toes. Take one more breath, slow and deep, all the way down into your tired, brave, beautiful body.

Let your eyes open, slow and soft.

If the baby is crying, go to them. You will know what to do. Maybe not perfectly. Maybe not the first time. But you will know. Your body knows. You have been preparing for this for nine months.

You did it, mama. You did the hardest, biggest, most extraordinary thing a human body can do. And you are still here. Still standing. Still loving. Still enough.

Welcome to motherhood. You are going to be wonderful at this. You already are.